



SPORTS

GAZING

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LAKELAND, FLA., MARCH 25. — JIMMY DYKES, THE cigar-chewing manager of the Detroit Tigers who can always be counted on for seven thousand well-chosen words on any phase of baseball, refuses to take part in the annual predictions debate.

"I'll let the others do the picking, and we'll just go along for the ride and hope for the best," Dykes bellowed from his perch in the Tiger dugout. "It wasn't too long ago that I read that (Al) Lopez (manager of the incumbent American League champs) had picked his team to repeat, and the next day he had them winning the World Series to boot.

"And who the hell dreams up all those fancy trades that I read and hear about. The other day one of the Chicago writers called and wanted to know if I had agreed to trade (Harvey) Kuenn for (Jim) Landis. Now wouldn't I have to have rocks in my head to even think of such a swap. Some of the trade propositions that you guys concoct are just fantastic.

"They said they would even be willing to throw in Earl Battey. There's a guy who doesn't catch more than a couple dozen games all year, and he doesn't even get to play in the spring."

Tom Ferrick, who operated as the Phillies' pitching coach last semester and currently holds the same title with the Tigers, admitted that both Don Mossi and Paul Foytack, two of the better members of the Detroit pitching corps, are having arm miseries. Mossi has a sore shoulder and Foytack is having elbow difficulties.

Both were in action in yesterday's game against the Phillies, and although they gave up a combined total of only four hits and held the Phils scoreless through the first six innings, they were having control difficulties. Mossi walked four batters in his three innings, and Foytack issued two walks.

Andy Cohen who came out of the wilds of El Paso, Tex., almost three decades ago to take over the second base chores with the New York Giants, says he has anxiously waited 20 years for his return to the major leagues. Andy ended his playing career with the Giants in 1939 and never had another opportunity to be connected with a major league club until he was offered a coaching job by the Phillies last December. "It's something I always wanted to do," Andy admits. "I dreamed about being back in the majors, but nobody ever offered me a job until I got that call from John Quinn."

During the 20-year absence from the big show, Andy has been a successful manager in the higher echelons of minor league baseball.

Andy likes to think back to his days with the giants, and his stories about John McGraw would fill several volumes . . . so would the recollections of his vaudeville stint with Shanty Hogan who was the No. 1 catcher for the Giants during that era.

"We made some of the old Keith Circuit," Andy recalls. "We weren't professional performers by any means, but did a lot of clowning and gagging, and some times we'd take part in an off-key duet."

Ted Lepeio, who came to the Phils along with outfielder Ken Walters and infielder Alex Cosmidas in the inter-league swap that sent pitcher Ray Semproch and infielder Chico Fernandez to Detroit, apparently isn't too happy with the move that brought him to the National League. "There's not a decent clubhouse in the whole league," Ted complains. "You should see the facilities at Fenway Park (Boston). There's wall-to-wall carpeting and individual showers and things like that. There's not one place in the National League that compares.

Ted, a late signer with the Phils, played seven seasons with the Red Sox before being traded to Detroit last May along with pitcher Dave Sisler. The Sox obtained Billy Hoelt in the deal.